

Inner layers

Energy from the core moves very slowly through the sun's layers. It can take more than 100,000 years to reach the surface!

Atmosphere

The sun's atmosphere stretches for thousands of miles into space.

Sunspots

Dark blotches called sunspots are cooler parts of the surface.

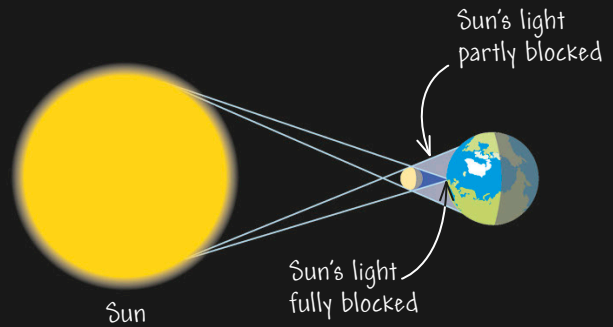
Surface

The sun's surface **emits**, or gives off, huge amounts of light, heat, and other energy, which travel out into space. Some of it reaches Earth.

Never look directly at the sun with the naked eye or through binoculars—bright sun can damage your eyes!

Solar eclipse

When the moon briefly passes between the sun and the Earth, it casts a shadow on Earth. We call this a **solar eclipse**. Sometimes, the sun's light is completely blocked by the moon's shadow. For a few minutes, day seems like night!



The sun's future

About 5 billion years from now, the sun will run out of fuel. It will swell up and its outer layers will blow away. Only the core will be left, which will slowly cool and fade away.

Light from the sun takes just over eight minutes to get to Earth.

